

For 9 years I have chased fantasies and dreams around K4. I've tried forcing my own will onto the cipher, I've probably made a fool of myself trying to solve it with techniques that do not belong to it and wasted countless hours of my life inventing numbers that do not exist, largely as a result of my own vanity and desire to "Be the one who breaks it using some magical, yet non-existent method of transposing one set of letters into another".

With K4, I think we have all set a trap for ourselves; I certainly fell into a deep one but there are also two very clever ones, one set for us by the sculpture itself, and the second set by our expectations around it.

For the second, I feel we are geared to over-engineering solutions based on the premise "This must be hard, the CIA, NSA, GCHQ and probably every other intelligence agency in the world can't break it"

I don't think this is true. I think its complexity comes from its simplicity and as I stated recently the bit that makes it hard is that we forget how to think like an artist and infer things that actually are not there.

For the first of the two traps; we're all caught up in solving the ciphertext.

Exactly how many of us can truly say we've solved the plaintext? I know I haven't. I might have found some of it but I'll bet it tells us a whole lot more. Answers on the back of a postcard addressed as the crow flies 23.5km *south east* of *CNBFLS*.

Avoid K4

K4 is completely irrelevant to solving it. Solving K4 should be a matter of putting pieces of the puzzle together. Once the puzzle is assembled, K4 will solve itself.

Speculation and conjecture.

I will be clear when I think I am speculating about something, and when I absolutely know I am applying conjecture. There is room for both but for every speculative piece of evidence brought to the table, I expect the legwork to be done to prove it. Until that point, it should be called out as such and I will try and highlight only the ones I believe are relevant.

On PALIMPSEST and ABSCISSA

I would like to talk briefly about these two keywords as they are not only important to solving the related passages 1 and 2 but I believe that they are also important towards passage 4.

The first of these is PALIMPSEST. No, it's not spelt PALIMPCEST, it doesn't have any religious meaning, it's not pointing to a specific scroll; I think we need to accept that the word is literally being given in its natural form and we need a very specific part of the meaning of this word.

Re-Use.

The meaning of the word **Palimpsest** is

- A manuscript or piece of writing material on which later writing has been superimposed on effaced earlier writing.
- something **reused or altered** but still bearing visible traces of its earlier form.

The part here that we are looking for is the reused or altered. I think both of these words have meaning here and I will try and demonstrate why I believe this to be the case a little later.

Why this keyword was chosen for passage 1, I believe is because it indicates that passage one will point you towards the section of the sculpture that will be both re-used. and altered in order to decipher passage 4.

Coordinate

The word **Abscissa** is chosen for passage 2. I believe that this is because Mr Sandborn is saying "You now have one half of the geometric position". If this is the case, we still have the ordinate to find.

There is another possible meaning to this word as well; in that Mr Sandborn is saying "I'm giving you one half of the cipher". Whilst this is both a contentious, and speculative reading of the word, it is, I believe still a valid assumption.

On LAQUEO and ASTATOS

Back in 2015, I noted that the misspellings and their counterparts were an anagram of the word LAQUEO. I have spent a considerable amount of time on this word over the years and I fully believe I have fallen into its meaning. In Latin, this word means "A trap" and yes, I think I fell into it. My current belief is that the misspellings of words are a deliberate trap to throw you off the cipher. Think of this in terms of Indiana Jones and a treasure map for the pyramids, littered with traps.

The breakthrough on me recognising this came when Rob McCleary discovered the word Greek word ASTATOS. This word literally means "Unstable" and I believe now that it's telling us that "This half of the cipher is unstable". To follow through with the treasure map analogy

“Here be dragons”. That said, just like any good Indiana Jones movie, we need to cross the dangerous part to get to the treasure. For why have a treasure map if it’s supposed to be easy?

Shading

In passage 1, we note the phrase

BETWEEN SUBTLE SHADING AND THE ABSENCE OF LIGHT LIES THE NUANCE
OF ILLUSION

For a while I have been thinking this related to something in the ciphertext but now I am firmly of the opinion that this relates to the plaintext.

Here, I think Mr Sandborn is pointing us directly to how half of the cipher works.

Consider the phrase, and reduce it down to its relevant components.

BETWEEN something AND something LIES something

Fill in the gaps and you get to

BETWEEN S S AND A L LIES N I

There are two key things to remember about illusions. One, in an illusion anything is POSSIBLE. and the second is that for an illusion to work, it has to be VISIBLE

But:

IT WAS TOT[AL]LY [IN]VISIBLE HOWS THAT PO[SS]IBLE

Here we find the letters AL, IN and SS but they are in the wrong order.

Place a pivot point between the I and the N and rotate it.

SS NI LA?

No, that’s wrong; think about how the moon works; it always shows the same face.

SS NI AL

This is almost certainly the ABSCISSA of the cipher.

Geo Magnetic Fields

In passage 2, we note the phrase as follows:

THEY USED THE EARTH’S MAGNETIC FIELD

In 1906, Bernard Brunhes made the first discovery of Geomagnetic reversal. published in his paper *Les variations de l'aimantation des terres volcaniques de la Chaîne des Puys et de l'Auvergne* [Variations in magnetization of volcanic rocks in the Chaîne des Puys and Auvergne].

This work was later built upon by Motonori Mat(s)uyama in 1929 in the paper "On the magnetization of rocks in Japan.", and again by the English Mathematician and geophysicist Harold Jeffreys in his 1948 paper "The Earth's Magnetic Field and its Secular Variation."

In the early 1950s, a team led by Lloyd V. Berkner discovered that the earths magnetic field was tilted at an angle of approximately 11° from the perpendicular.

 I want to also place a warning to anyone looking to follow this research; stick to the relevant facts. We know Mr Sandborn has an interest in Atomic reaction ([Atomic Time](https://books.google.com/books/about/Atomic_Time.html?id=F9TpAAAAAAAJ&redir_esc=y) (https://books.google.com/books/about/Atomic_Time.html?id=F9TpAAAAAAAJ&redir_esc=y), [Critical Assembly](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Critical_Assembly) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Critical_Assembly)). Those researching the Geomagnetic field, will undoubtedly come across [Dynamo theory](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dynamo_theory) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dynamo_theory). This will innevitably lead towards [Patrick Blacket](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Patrick_Blackett) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Patrick_Blackett), who introduced a theory on the Earths magnetic field as a function of rotation, a theory he later contradicted in his paper "The Diurnal Variation of the Earth's Magnetic Field". My understanding is that Blackett would later go on to be instrumental in aligning Britain with America on the creation of the Atomic bomb. This is almost certainly irrelevant to the sculpture KRYPTOS. Don't get caught up in the speculative, stick to only what you can see.

Key points

1. The magnetic field is tilted 11° off the perpendicular. This **may** be indicative of a Ceasar shift somewhere in the cipher. If so, the shift is most likely to be of 11.
2. The magentic field periodically flips over.

In my understanding, Mr Sandborn has made several references to "Flipping" and "Turning" in relation to K4. Lets keep this in mind.

Intervals

There is another potential element of misdirection at play here. K2 contains 5 X symbols in total.

If we imagine K2 being a conversation between two people, the X symbols indicate a change of speaker when a question is not being asked, or a pause in the conversation which is then followed by a piece of information.

Person 1. IT WAS TOTALLY INVISIBLE HOWS THAT POSSIBLE ?

Person 2. THEY USED THE EARTH'S MAGNETIC FIELD X

Person 2. THE INFORMATION WAS GATHERED AND TRANSMITTED
UNDERGROUND TO AN UNKNOWN LOCATION X

Person 1. DOES LANGLEY KNOW ABOUT THIS ?

Person 2. THEY SHOULD IT'S BURIED OUT THERE SOMEWHERE X

Person 1. WHO KNOWS THE EXACT LOCATION ?

Person 2. ONLY WW THIS WAS HIS LAST MESSAGE X

Person 2. THIRTY EIGHT DEGREES FIFTY SEVEN MINUTES SIX POINT FIVE
SECONDS NORTH SEVENTY SEVEN DEGREES EIGHT MINUTES FORTY FOUR
SECONDS WEST X

Person 2. LAYER TWO

It is possible, that these indications are telling you when to change direction in the cipher; or a cadence in which to read the letters but both of these options are only conjecture until proven otherwise.

Note the person to whom the Xs belong. Person 1 never contains an X, Person 2 has 5 of them.

One of the reasons I think this, is that in Morse code, an X was occasionally used to indicate a pause or a break between sections.

If that were the case in this message, there should be more Xs (for example between INVISIBLE and HOW, and between WW and THIS); Overall, the beat or cadence of this section feels off.

If this was to be a cadence, then the pattern will almost certainly be
1 – 2 – 2 – 1 – 2 – 1 – 2 – 2 – 2 as this is the order that the speakers appear.

Speculatively, some of this also makes me wonder if X LAYER 2 doesn't mean LAYER 2 at all, but actually indicates 22:00; why? In a discussion containing the earth's magnetic field, then 2×11 is 22, if the X is taken as the roman numeral 10, then the second 10 in the day is 22:00.

One note that bothers me about the cadence is that it implies a second passage to read from. This might not be a problem as there is another plaintext passage of interest that contains all the letters of interest (SS NI AL), in their correct order:

SLOWLYDESPARATLYSLOWLYTHEREMAINSOFPA SS AGEDEBRISTHATENCUMBE
REDTHELOWERPARTOFTHEDOORWAYWASREMOVEDWITHTREMBLINGHANDSIM
ADEATINYBREACHINTHEUPPERLEFTHANDCORNERANDTHENWIDE NI NGTHEHO
LE AL ITTLEIINSERTEDTHECANDLE

Tutankhamun and the raiders of the missing candle

Now I come to K3 and the discussion of Howard Carters discovery of the tomb of Tutankhamun. Most of this is conjecture. I think I've not yet fully understood this passage.

Removing the rubble

SLOWLY THE REMAINS OF PASSAGE DEBRIS THAT ENCUMBERED THE LOWER PART OF THE DOORWAY WAS REMOVED

I am coming to the conclusion here that K4 is either 1 letter too long, or 5 letters too short. Either way, I am thinking the R needs to go. This would make the cipher 96 characters which splits nicely over 6, 8 and 12 columns, or:

I INSERTED THE CANDLE

How do you dispell illusions? How do you reveal something that hides in shadows? By shining a light.

I think at this point we're supposed to insert a keyword that is indicative of the word light. Whether that is CANDLE, FLAME, or even VISIBLE I do not yet know. What I do understand is that the keyword is VISIBLE within the cipher.

Some of this makes sense to me, other parts do not and this is really where i am up to with deciphering the plaintext. No, not every question has been answered and not every detail worked out but this is where I am.

AND THEN WIDENING THE HOLE A LITTLE

For any of these keywords to fit, it may be that we have to remove more of K4 than we previously thought.

My current options are:

- Remove R from the end and insert CANDLE at the beginning (96 chars)
- Remove the R from the end and remove OBKR from the beginning to insert NDLE from candle after the CA at the end (96 chars)
- Use the word FLAME and keep all of k4 (102 characters)
- Use the keyword VISIBLE somewhere (Up to 104 characters)
- None of the above

Finally

CAN YOU SEE ANYTHING Q

I'm not the first person to think this is a question directed at the character Q but given that the best place to look for something is from an elevated position, I personally believe that this question is being called up to the Q in IQLUSION who I imagine answering "No, I'm in the dark"